

Shakeup at RIM

RIM Co-CEOs Mike Lazaridis and Jim Balsillie were demoted from their positions. Thorsten Heins is the new CEO of RIM

Social media losing its charm

According to a recent survey by Assocham, India's urban youth is slowly spending less and less time on social networking sites

Bazaar

ASUS PA246Q

An affordable professional grade monitor

Belonging to the Pro Art series of monitors, the ASUS PA246Q is a monitor meant for professional designers and photographers. Its a 24-inch Professional IPS (P-IPS) panel monitor with a native resolution of 1920x1200 and it uses CCFL backlighting thus explaining its bulky form factor. The monitor

is surrounded by a matte black bezel and it has a very sturdy stand which allows you to tilt, swivel, adjust monitor height as well as pivot by 90 degrees to go from landscape to portrait mode (but you will have to manually change the display orientation).

The OSD offers many tweaking options including six axis hue/saturation, gain control; the QuickFit button provides real-size document grid atop the window, etc. There are around five picture preset modes including sRGB, Adobe RGB, User among others.

At 50 per cent brightness and 75 percent contrast in the User mode, we got a contrast ratio of 526:1 with the

Spyder 3 Elite colorimeter. The black levels were around 0.32. You can tweak the calibrations to your liking. It passed most of the Lagom.nl tests which tests the monitor's black to white gradient level, the colour bands were distinctly visible across all colours, only in the Inversion test which involves various moire patterns on the screen did we notice some flickering in 2 out of 11 tests.

Text was rendered well and watching full HD content was a joy. Although we did not find the blacks to be very deep. There was absolutely no banding or noise in the solid coloured areas.

At ₹29,000 this is probably one of the more affordable professional grade monitors.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Display size: 24-inch; **Panel:** P-IPS; **Display Ports:** HDMI, D Sub, DVI, DisplayPort; **Display Colors:** 1073.7M (10-bit); **Resolution:** 1920x1200

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1800 209 0365
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Website: www.asus.in
Price: ₹29,000



7.5/10

Features	7.5
Performance.....	7.5
Build Quality	8.5
Value for Money	7.0

ASRock X79 Extreme 9

An enthusiast's companion with massive storage connectors

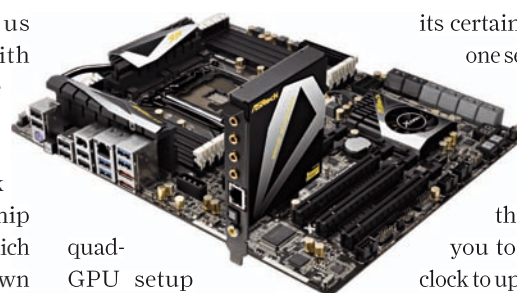
Specifications

Form Factor: ATX; **Chipset:** Intel X79; **DIMM slots:** 8; **Back Panel Ports:** 4xUSB 3.0, 6xUSB 2.0, 2xeSATA, 1xLAN port; **Expansion slots:** 5xPCIe 3.0 x16, 1xPCIe 2.0 x1; **SATA 6 Gbps ports:** 8

Contact

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Price: ₹27,999

ASRock had us impressed with their feature packed Z68 Extreme 7 Gen 3 board. With the new X79 chipset, ASRock has come out with its flagship board – the X79 Extreme 9 which sports the similar black, brown and gold colour combination. The sharp designs on the heat-sinks are impressive and the heatsink over the X79 chipset has an onboard fan that drives the heat downwards. It comes with five PCIe slots with support for PCIe 3.0 standard. There are as many as 12 SATA ports including two eSATA ports and two USB 3.0 headers which takes care of most of your storage device connection needs. You can run a



quad-GPU setup in x8/x8/x8/x8 mode or dual-GPUs in x16/x16 setup.

Absence of audio and mic jack is filled with the Creative Sound Core3D PCIe x1 card along with Broadcom BCM57781 LAN PCB module which is bundled in what's called the GameBlaster.

Build quality is extremely good and the overall layout leaves little to complain about. The UEFI BIOS looks good, but

its certainly not as great as the one seen on ASUS Rampage IV Extreme. Overclocking module offers easy clock presets to overclock the processor, allowing you to take base multiplier clock to upto 60x. Two digit error readout LEDs and dedicated power/reset buttons are great for enthusiasts. We could overclock it to upto 4.15 GHz on air which gave a significant improvement in scores.

The pricing of ₹27,999 is on the higher side specially when you consider its competitor, the ASUS Rampage IV Extreme which comes for a mere ₹700 more and packs in a lot of innovative features.

Nimish Sawant

7.0/10

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Performance.....	7.5
Build Quality	8.5
Value for Money	5.5